DRAGON AND CRANE DOJO

Traditional Karate

Adapted for Today

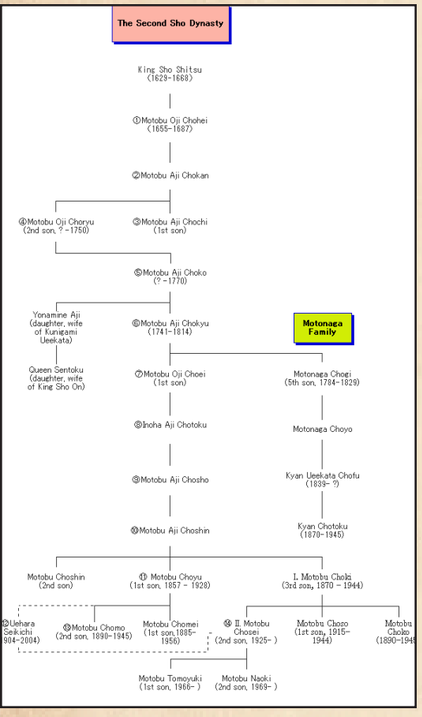
Welcome Series
3 - Dojo Lineage

v0.1

DOJO LINEAGE

Origins:

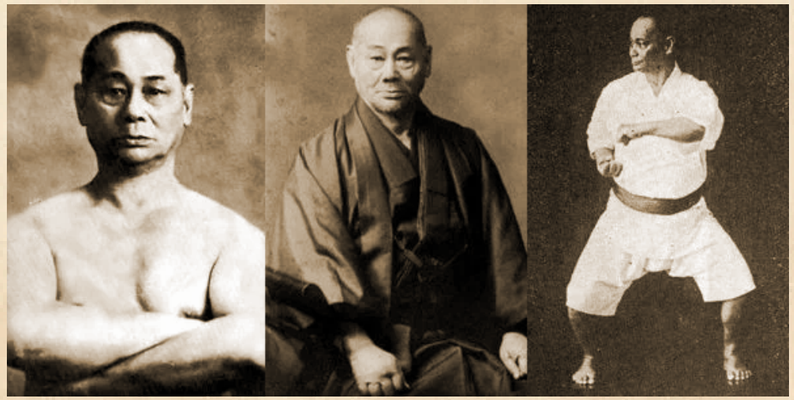
Okinawan Motobu-ryu



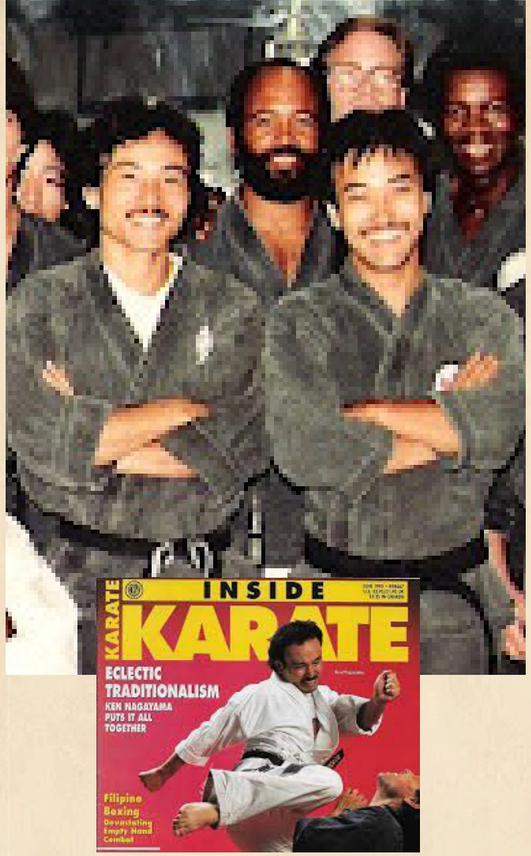
Centuries ago, the Ryukyu Kingdom on the island chain of Okinawa adapted the kempo of its Chinese trading partners to its native martial arts into a style called te.

Over time, each region - and sometimes even individual aristocratic families - began to develop their own signature styles. One such family was the Motobu clan, who adapted traditional Okinawan dance with their combat into their Motobu-ryu style.

After Okinawa became annexed into Japan, several of its traditional styles were further adapted by Japan and Korea, contributing to Karate and Taekwondo, respectively.



from motobu-ryu.org



DOJO LINEAGE

Style:

Master Nagayama and KNMA Karate

Born in Okinawa and trained in a foundation of Motobu-ryu to 4th degree, Ken Nagayama immigrated to southern California in 1976. He soon met and befriended Jun Chong, a Taekwondo dojang owner from Korea. The two collaborated on teaching as well as the film Best of the Best.

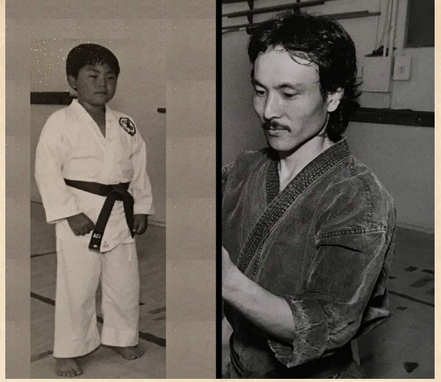
In 1988, Nagayama founded his own dojo, Ken Nagayama Martial Arts in Burbank, California. The KNMA system adapted Okinawan Motobu-ryu, Chong's TKD, Japanese Aikido, and Western Boxing into a blend unique for its day, described by Inside Karate magazine as "Eclectic Traditionalism".

The breadth of styles taught at KNMA is matched by the depth of mastery and rigor required to meet Nagayama's exacting standards.

DOJO LINEAGE

Chung Sensei:

From the Mat
to the Campus
into the Office
and Back Again



David Chung started training with Master Nagayama at age 7, and continued at KNMA until he left California for college 2 weeks after earning his 2nd dan black belt.

While working as a software engineer, he trained in an array of other martial arts (Shaolin and Wing Chun kung fu, to Brazilian Capoeira, and boxing) as well as circus arts (Chinese lion dance, Parkour, acro balance, and aerial silks), that built on the foundation honed at KNMA of deliberate practice,,body awareness, and focus.

At the same time, he noticed the how much his career was indebted to public speaking, group organization, and problem decomposition skills first honed on the mat teaching Karate.

In 2018 he moved back to Los Angeles with the intent of adapting his collected skills - both martial and performative, athletic and professional - into a new kind of Karate curriculum.

Absorb what is useful.
Discard what is useless.
Add what is essentially your own.
-Bruce Lee

DOJO LINEAGE

Founding the Dojo:

Carrying on
the Tradition
of Adaptation

Dragon and Crane Dojo opened its doors in August 2021.

In this era of global retail chains, the traditional dojo is a bastion of small business ownership, in large part because the sensei's influences are both deeply personal and highly visible. .DCD wears its KNMA lineage on its sleeve (or belt) while forging its own identity. This adaptation is itself tribute to Master Nagayama's "electic traditionalism" that built upon the Motobu-ryu (and Judo, Kendo, Aikido, Taekwondo, and boxing) that preceded him.

As an organization, DCD is separate from KNMA with its own content, instruction style, and philsophy, but the schools maintain a close working relationship. DCD students train regularly and test at KNMA. Master Nagayama and several black belts and students have also provided support for the dojo during its launch and subsequently, for which the school is deeply grateful.

DCD students have competed in tournaments hosted at the schools of both Masters Ken Nagayama and Jun Chong, extending the chain by another generation.

Dragon and Crane Dojo strives to uphold Master Nagayama's tradition of broad influences, high standards, and flexible adaptation.

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A downloadable PDF of this document as well as others in the series can be found on the Learning Resources page of the dojo website at dragonandcranedojo.com/learn/

9514 Sepulveda Blvd, 91343
dragonandcranedojo@gmail.com
747-333-6030
dragonandcranedojo.com
#dragonandcranedojo
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